

OLAWUNMI MUTIU FAKOREDE

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics
Department of Economics, University of Utah
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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Health Economics · Labor Economics · Development Economics · Welfare Economics · Public Economics · Law & Economics · Political Economy

RESEARCH PROFILE

Health, finance, labor, and development economist studying how economic vulnerability, economic shocks, caregiving responsibilities, mental health systems, financial conditions, and labor-market institutions shape productivity, welfare, and population health outcomes.

My research integrates applied micro-econometrics, macro-micro analysis, vulnerability measurement, welfare valuation, cost-of-illness estimation, and policy evaluation, using administrative health records, survey data, policy panels, longitudinal datasets, and time-series methods.

JOB MARKET PAPERS

Psychiatric Service Utilization, Vulnerability, and Economic Burden under Nigeria's Pre-2023 Mental Health System

This paper examines psychiatric service utilization and economic vulnerability under Nigeria's pre-2023 mental health system. Using patient-level psychiatric records, macroeconomic indicators, and major crisis shocks - including the Global Financial Crisis, Ebola epidemic, and COVID-19 pandemic - the study develops a Mental Health Vulnerability Index (MHVI), estimates pathways of psychiatric service utilization, and quantifies productivity losses and the broader economic burden associated with mental illness.

Measuring and Valuing Structural Caregiver Vulnerability in the United States

This paper examines the multidimensional vulnerability of family caregivers in the United States. Using nationally representative Behavioral Risk Factor Surveillance System (BRFSS) data, the study develops a Caregiver Vulnerability Index (CVI) integrating material hardship, personal health burden, and social disadvantage; applies a Leave-One-Out (LOO) identification framework to assess the contribution of individual vulnerability domains; and estimates Marginal Compensation Rates (MCRs) to quantify the income-equivalent economic valuation of caregiver vulnerability and its implications for health, wellbeing, and social policy.

WORKING PAPERS & RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

Labor Market Institutional Generosity, Economic Risk Protection, and Population Mental Health in the United States, 1999–2021: Examines the relationship between labor-market institutional generosity, economic risk protection, and population mental health across U.S. states.

How Worthy is Thy Skin Tone? A Socioeconomic Analysis in Nigeria: Examines the socioeconomic consequences of skin tone and colorism in Nigeria, with particular attention to socioeconomic inequality and labor-market outcomes.

Gendered Crises: Economic Shocks, Epidemics, and Mental Health in Nigeria, 2000–2023: Investigates gender differences in the relationship between major economic and epidemiological shocks and mental health outcomes in Nigeria.

Labor Market Institutional Generosity and Birth Outcomes in the United States: With Megan Reynolds. Examines the relationship between state-level labor-market institutional generosity and birth outcomes in the United States.

Colonial Educational Legacy, Human Capital Formation, and Migration in Nigeria: Investigates the long-run effects of colonial educational institutions on human capital formation, migration, and the allocation of skilled workers in Nigeria.

Fueling Inflation: PMS Pump Price Pass-Through to Staple Food Prices in Nigeria: Examines how Premium Motor Spirit (PMS) pump-price changes transmit to staple food prices and their implications for household economic welfare.

EDUCATION

University of Utah - Salt Lake City, Utah

- Ph.D. in Economics | August 2023–Present
Fields: Health Economics; Labor Economics; Development Economics; Welfare Economics; Law, Economics & Policy
Dissertation Committee: Fernando Wilson (Chair), Norm Waitzman, Sarah Small, Megan Reynolds, Francisco Perez

University of San Francisco - San Francisco, California

- M.Sc. in International & Development Economics | 2022 | GPA: 3.96/4.00 | Valedictorian

University of Agriculture, Abeokuta - Ogun State, Nigeria

- B.Sc. in Agricultural Economics | 2006 | GPA: 4.74/5.00 · First Class Honors

Federal Polytechnic, Offa - Kwara State, Nigeria

- HND/B.Sc. in Food Science & Technology | 2004 | GPA: 3.44/4.00

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

University of Utah - Salt Lake City, Utah

Graduate Research Assistant | July 2023–Present

Research across the Departments/units of Economics, Sociology, and the School of Medicine/College of Nursing. Research activities include:

- Mental health economics and psychiatric service utilization
- Administrative health-record analysis
- Caregiver vulnerability and caregiving intensity
- Labor-market institutions and paid family leave
- BRFSS and population-health analysis
- Policy evaluation and quasi-experimental methods
- Vulnerability measurement and welfare analysis
- Cost-of-illness estimation and productivity-loss measurement
- Socioeconomic disparities and population health

University of San Francisco - San Francisco, California

Research Assistant, Department of Economics | December 2021–June 2022 | NLSY79 database

Jesuit Foundation Research Grant | 2021–2022

SELECTED RESEARCH PROJECTS

- *The Dose-Response Relationship Between Caregiving Intensity and Mental Health Among Older Adults: Findings from a U.S. National Sample*
- *Gender Differences in Financial and Work-Related Outcomes Among U.S. Family Caregivers*
- *Caregiving in Utah: A Policy Brief for the Utah Legislature*
- *Legal Mapping and Evaluation of Mental Health and Substance Use Statutes in Illinois*
- *Labor Market Institutional Generosity and Birth Outcomes in the United States*
- *From Colonialism to Comprador Capitalism: Nigeria's Unfinished Liberation*
- *Is Africa Up for Grabs Again? An Analysis of Trade Structure, Flow and Volume*
- *The Economic History of Colonial Legacy and the Crisis of Educational Systems in Nigeria: A World-Systems Approach to Economic Dependency, Cultural Hegemony, and Migration*
- *Availability, Accessibility, Acceptability, Quality & Utilization (A3QU) of Healthcare in Malawi*

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Utah - Department of Economics

- Instructor, Intermediate Macroeconomics (ECON 4020) | Summer 2026
- Teaching Assistant/Grader, Health Economics (ECON 3190) | Spring 2026

- Instructor, Health Economics (ECON 3190) | Fall 2025
- Teaching Assistant/Grader, Health Economics (ECON 3190) | Spring 2025
- Teaching Assistant/Grader, Principles of Microeconomics (ECON 2010) | Fall 2023, Spring 2024, Fall 2024

University of San Francisco, CA

- Teaching Assistant, Development Microeconomics (ECON 625) | Spring 2022
- Teaching Assistant, Mathematics for Economics (ECON 621) | Fall 2021

METHODS & TECHNICAL SKILLS

Econometric Methods: Causal Inference · Difference-in-Differences · Instrumental Variables · Regression Discontinuity · Survey Methods · System GMM · ARDL · Error Correction Models · VAR · Granger Causality

Research Methods: Vulnerability Measurement · Welfare Valuation · Cost-of-Illness Analysis · Policy Evaluation · Policy Simulation · Mixed Methods

Software: Stata · R · MATLAB · GIS · Dedoose

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- Work and Family Researchers Network (WFRN) Conference | 2026 | Presenter
- Western States Graduate Workshop/Conference in Economics (WSGCE) | 2023, 2024 | Presenter
- Pacific Conference for Development Economics (PACDEV) | 2022 | Presenter
- University of Utah Graduate Seminar Series | 2023–2025 | Presenter

CONFERENCE PARTICIPATION

- Mountain West Economic History Conference (MWEHC) | 2024, 2025, 2026 Participant

RESEARCH OUTPUTS & EARLIER PROJECTS

1. *Does My Skin Tone Really Matter? A Socioeconomic Analysis in Nigeria*. M.Sc. Thesis, University of San Francisco, Spring 2022.
2. *Perception of Prestige and Dominance in Leadership Based on Non-Verbal Cues*. Experimental Economics project, University of San Francisco, 2021. Mutiu F. et al.*
3. *Impact of Control Distance on Frequency & Magnitude of Business Fraud: Control Environment Review*. Commercial banking sector project, Nigeria, 2012.
4. *Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) Competency & Capacity Assessments: Requirements for Accessing Cottage Loans*. Conducted in liaison with development finance institutions, including the Bank of Agriculture and Bank of Industry, Nigeria, 2011–2014.

5. *Market Readiness Assessment of Selected Agricultural Value Chain Crops*. United Nations World Food Programme, Zambia, 2016.
6. *Development of Domestic & International Market for Cowpea*. With TechnoServe Zambia; submitted to the United Nations World Food Programme, 2017.
7. *Impact Assessment of Lowland FADAMA II*. Research Assistant, World Bank-assisted project, Ogun State Agricultural Development Programme (OGADEP), Nigeria, 2006–2007.
8. *Comparative Economic Analyses of 'Kampala' Marketing Among Cooperators/Non-Cooperators in Abeokuta South LGA*. B.Sc. Research Project, University of Agriculture, Abeokuta, 2006.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- African Export-Import Bank (Afreximbank) | Risk Audit & Compliance Consultant | July 2020–April 2024
- University of San Francisco | Analyst, Office of the Provost | August 2022–July 2023
- Triumph Care LLC - Nashville, Tennessee | Data Compliance & Quality Assurance | June 2022–July 2023
- Wood Mackenzie / PCG Consulting | Vice President, Strategy & Performance Improvement Consultant | September 2018–July 2020
- Counter-Fraud Learning Centre - Lagos, Nigeria | Chief Operating Officer | September 2019–June 2020
- UN World Food Programme | Int'l Consultant, Programme Policy | September 2016–August 2018
- PML Advisory Limited – Nigeria | Associate Director / Head, Governance, Risk & Compliance | January 2015–September 2016
- KPMG | Deputy Manager / Senior III, Financial Risk Management | September 2009–December 2014
- FinBank Nigeria | Enterprise Risk Management Officer | April 2008–September 2009
- Niger State College of Education – Nigeria | Economics Lecturer | February 2007–March 2008
- Research Assistant | World Bank-Assisted FADAMA Project – Nigeria | October 2006–February 2007

AWARDS, GRANTS & HONORS

- NEXUS Scholarship Grant, University of Utah – 202/2027
- Jewell J. & Larue J. Rasmussen Endowment Fund Scholarship, University of Utah – 2026/2027
- 1st Runner-Up, 3-Minute Thesis (3MT) Competition, University of Utah - 2025
- Jewell J. & Larue J. Rasmussen Endowment Fund Scholarship, University of Utah - 2024
- Graduate Valedictorian/Commencement Speaker, University of San Francisco - 2022
- Jacques Arthur Best Graduate Economics Student Award, University of San Francisco - 2022
- Cultural Center Vizuri Kabisa Academic Excellence Award, University of San Francisco - 2022
- International Student Ambassador Achievement Award, China Business Studies Institute, University of San Francisco - 2022

- Jesuit Foundation Research Grant (\$5,000), University of San Francisco - 2021
- NABE Diversity Scholars Award, National Association for Business Economics - 2021
- USF African Scholars Award - 2020
- First Class Honors Award, University of Agriculture, Abeokuta - 2006

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- Work & Family Researchers Network (WFRN)
- Pan African Scientific Research Council (PASRC)
- Nigerian Institute of Management (NIM)
- Institute of Chartered Accountants of Nigeria (ICAN)
- Global Association of Risk Professionals (GARP)
- The Institute of Internal Auditors (IIA)
- Association of Certified Fraud Examiners (ACFE)
- Chartered Institute of Management Accountants (CIMA)

LANGUAGES

English: Fluent | Yoruba: Fluent | Arabic: Conversational | French: Basic

ACADEMIC REFEREES

Professor Fernando Wilson

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Professor Francisco Perez

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Professor Bruce Wydick

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San Francisco, California, United States | wydick@usfca.edu · +1 (415) 422-5863

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References available upon request.